

```
password --md5 <encrypted form of password>
```

Save the file and exit.

Now when we boot into the machine, at the GRUB prompt, editing GRUB parameters will require the password 'grub' (set at the first option).

Now select the Linux OS and press *Enter*. You will have to give the password 'linux' (set at the second option) in order to boot into the Linux OS.

At the GRUB prompt, choose *Other/Windows* and press *Enter*. You will have to give the password 'windows' (set at the third option) in order to boot into the Windows OS.

Don't these simple steps make your system more secure?

—Sudipta Bhar, sudiptabhar2006@gmail.com



How to wipe and erase a hard disk

Worried about your data when you dispose of your hard disk? Here's a method that will destroy all your data forever.

Shred is installed on most Linux systems. So issue the following command...

```
shred -v -n 1 -z /dev/hdc
```

...where each symbol results in the following tasks:

- v: shows progress
- n 1: overwrites the hard disk with one pass of random data instead of default
- z: finishes cleaning with one pass of zeros



Note: This will erase all your data from the HDD. So, be very careful while running this command.

—Gururaj Raghavendra Rao, raogrr@rediffmail.com



How do you send messages to other users?

You can do this using the *write* command, which sends messages to other users' terminals:

```
$write username OR tty name
```

The shell prompt will wait for the message you want to send to the user mentioned above, via a standard input. (You can also communicate with multiple users at the same time by using multiple *write* commands.) You can prevent users, other than the root user, from sending messages. The message is only displayed if the recipient replies with:

```
$msg y
```

The recipient can also communicate using the *write* command. If you do not want to receive the messages, use the following command:

```
$msg n
```

So, enjoy sending messages to other users.

—Boddu Chandra Kaladhar, kaladhar2105@gmail.com



Editing multiple files in a single VIM editor

Open the file using the VIM editor. For example:

```
vim file.c
```

Now if you want to open another file and also want the *file.c* to stay open, just press *Esc* and then *:sp "your_file"* (without quotes). This will split the window and open 'your file' along with 'file.c'. You now have two files open in the same VIM editor. Using *sp(split)* you can open multiple files. For example:

```
:sp file2.c
```

```
:sp file3.c
```

This will split the screen whenever you open a new file using *sp*. You can select the file pressing *CTRL+w+w*. You have to do this till you reach the specified file you want.

The window will be split into small parts. For more readability, you can enlarge the specified file using the *on* command. Press *Esc* and type:

```
:on
```

The file you are in will be maximised, and the rest will not be visible. After making all the files visible, apply the command *ba*. Press *Esc* and type:

```
:ba
```

—Anoop Ayadathil, a.anoop@gdatech.co.in

END

Share Your Linux Recipes!

The joy of using Linux is in finding ways to get around problems—take them head on, defeat them! We invite you to share your tips and tricks with us for publication in LFY so that they can reach a wider audience. Your tips could be related to administration, programming, troubleshooting or general tweaking. Submit them at www.linuxforu.com. The sender of each published tip will get an LFY T-shirt.